

# JOCHEM VANAGT

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## EDUCATION

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|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| 2022 – 2026       | <b>Ph.D.</b> in Political Science                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | UNIVERSITY OF ANTWERP & KU LEUVEN, BELGIUM |
|                   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>– Dissertation: <i>Beyond the Two-Party Divide: How Coalition Dynamics and Ideological Orientations Redefine Affective Polarization in Europe</i></li><li>– Supervisors: Prof. Dr. Stefaan Walgrave (University of Antwerp), Prof. Dr. Ellen Claes (KU Leuven), Dr. Luana Russo (Maastricht University)</li></ul>                                                                      |                                            |
| 03.2024 – 05.2024 | Visiting Researcher                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | UNIVERSITY OF VIENNA, AUSTRIA              |
| 2020 – 2022       | <b>M.Sc.</b> (research) in European Studies                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | MAASTRICHT UNIVERSITY, NETHERLANDS         |
|                   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>– Distinction: <i>Cum Laude</i> (GPA: 88%)</li><li>– Thesis title: <i>For Richer or For Poorer, Polarisation Affects Us All: A Two-Stage Comparative Analysis of the Economic Foundations of Affective Polarisation in Europe</i> (grade: 9/10)</li><li>– Specialisations: Quantitative Methodology, Survey Research Design, Governance &amp; Representation</li></ul>                 |                                            |
| 2017 – 2020       | <b>B.Sc.</b> in Medicine                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | ANTWERP UNIVERSITY, BELGIUM                |
|                   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>– Distinction: <i>Magna Cum Laude</i> (GPA: 77%)</li><li>– Medical internships: human genetics, cardiology, gastroenterology</li><li>– Summer courses: genetic engineering (Aarhus University, Denmark), international business and political science (King's College London, United Kingdom), macro-economics and financial investment (Maastricht University, Netherlands)</li></ul> |                                            |

## RESEARCH

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Research Fields: Political Behaviour, Comparative Politics, Political Psychology

Research Interests: Affective Polarisation, Partisanship, Radical-Right Support, Political Involvement, Democratic Support <sup>†</sup>

### PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- (5) **Vanagt, J.**, Praprotnik, K., Russo, L. & Wagner, M. (2025) Partisan Affect and Political Tolerance in the Context of Shifting Norms: The Effect of Coalition Signals towards the Radical Right. *Journal of European Public Policy*. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13501763.2025.2558980>
- (4) **Vanagt, J.**<sup>†</sup> & Kollberg, M.<sup>†</sup> (2025) United in Success, Fragmented in Failure: The Moderating Effect of Perceived Government Performance on Affective Polarisation between Coalition Partners. *European Journal of Political Research*. <https://doi.org/10.1111/1475-6765.70012>
- (3) **Vanagt, J.** & Russo, L. (2024) The Economic Divide That Isn't: A Comparative Study on Economic Hardship and Affective Polarisation. *Research & Politics*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/20531680241292410>
- (2) **Vanagt, J.**, Praprotnik, K., Russo, L. & Wagner, M. (2024) Affective Polarization Among Radical-Right Supporters: Dislike Differentiation and Democratic Support. *Politics and Governance*. <https://doi.org/10.17645/pag.8531>
- (1) **Vanagt, J.** (2024) Appraising Measurements of Affective Polarisation in Multiparty Systems: Comparative Insights from the Low Countries. *Politics of the Low Countries. Online First*. <https://doi.org/10.5553/PLC/.000068>.

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<sup>†</sup>Equal authorship marked with †

## WORK IN PROGRESS

- (6) Polarized Yet Committed: Why Affective Polarization Might Not Undermine Democracy, *with Emma Turkenburg, Markus Wagner*
- (5) Re-Ostracizing the Radical Right? Quasi-Experimental Evidence from an Election Panel, *with Laura Jacobs, Bjarn Eck, Jean-Benoit Pilet*
- (4) Public support for the cordon sanitaire in Belgium. Exploring the impact of institutionalization, *with Bjarn Eck, Jean-Benoit Pilet, Laura Jacobs*
- (3) Rethinking Political Identity in Europe: Partisan and Ideological Attachment in Times of Affective Polarization, *with Luana Russo*
- (2) Let's (Not) Disagree: How Tolerance for Disagreement Shapes Horizontal Affective Polarisation, *with Luana Russo*
- (1) The Low Countries (Belgium & the Netherlands): Balancing National Diversity with Supranational Integration. In T. D. Lancaster (Ed.), *Comparative European Politics*. Taylor & Francis Group, *with Bjarn Eck*

## CONFERENCES &amp; WORKSHOPS

|      |                                                         |                                    |
|------|---------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| 2025 | APSA Annual Meeting                                     | VANCOUVER, CANADA                  |
|      | Annual Political Science Workshops of the Low Countries | GRONINGEN UNIVERSITY, NETHERLANDS  |
|      | ECPR Joint Sessions                                     | PRAGUE, CZECHIA                    |
| 2024 | ECPR General Conference                                 | UNIVERSITY COLLEGE DUBLIN, IRELAND |
|      | EPSA 14 <sup>th</sup> Annual Conference                 | COLOGNE, GERMANY                   |
|      | Annual Political Science Workshops of the Low Countries | MAASTRICHT UNIVERSITY, NETHERLANDS |
| 2023 | Symposium on Affective Polarisation                     | MAASTRICHT UNIVERSITY, NETHERLANDS |
|      | ECPR General Conference                                 | CHARLES UNIVERSITY, CZECHIA        |
|      | EPSA 13 <sup>th</sup> Annual Conference                 | GLASGOW, UNITED KINGDOM            |
|      | Annual Political Science Workshops of the Low Countries | KU LEUVEN, BELGIUM                 |
| 2022 | ECPR General Conference                                 | UNIVERSITY OF INNSBRUCK, AUSTRIA   |
|      | UACES Graduate Forum Conference                         | MAASTRICHT UNIVERSITY, NETHERLANDS |
|      | Annual Political Science Workshops of the Low Countries | RADBOD UNIVERSITY, NETHERLANDS     |

## SUMMER SCHOOLS &amp; METHODS TRAINING

|      |                                                          |                                     |
|------|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| 2024 | Summer school "Democratic Decline and Resilience"        | UNIVERSITY OF MONTRÉAL, CANADA      |
|      | Prof. Dr. Ruth Dassonneville and Prof. Dr. Romain Lachet |                                     |
| 2023 | PhD course "Political Psychology"                        | LUND UNIVERSITY, SWEDEN             |
|      | Prof. Dr. Hanna Bäck and Prof. Dr. Magnus Lindén         |                                     |
|      | Summer school "Surveying Hard-To-Reach Populations"      | UNIVERSITY OF ESSEX, UNITED KINGDOM |
|      | Dr. Alessandra Gaia                                      |                                     |
|      | Summer school "Electoral Democracy in Danger?"           | SCIENCES PO PARIS, FRANCE           |
|      | Prof. Dr. Ruth Dassonneville and Prof. Dr. Romain Lachet |                                     |
|      | Workshop "Experimental Methods"                          | GHENT UNIVERSITY, BELGIUM           |
|      | Prof. Dr. Bert Bakker                                    |                                     |
| 2022 | Workshop "Statistical Power Analysis"                    | KU LEUVEN, BELGIUM                  |
|      | Dr. Niklas Johannes                                      |                                     |

Summer school “Causal Inference and Experiments” UNIVERSITY OF ESSEX, UNITED KINGDOM  
Prof. Dr. Ryan T. Moore

Workshop “Applied Multiple Imputation” GESIS, GERMANY

Winter school “Multilevel Structural Equation Modelling” KU LEUVEN, BELGIUM  
Prof. Dr. Bruno Castanho Silva

## GRANTS & FUNDING

2022 ECPR Winter School Participation Grant: £ 465

## TEACHING & ADVISING

2025 Public Speaker & Science Communicator BELGIUM  
Various lectures to general public on *Causes and Consequences of Ideological Differences and Emotions in Politics*

2023 – 2025 Tutor & Teaching Assistant UANTWERPEN, BELGIUM  
Course on *European Integration* by Prof. Dr. Peter Bursens  
Course on *International Relations* by Prof. Dr. Dirk de Bièvre  
Course on *Political Behavior* by Prof. Dr. Peter Thijssen

2024 Guest Lecturer UANTWERPEN, BELGIUM  
Guest lecture on *Affective Polarisation in the U.S. and Europe*

Keynote Speaker UANTWERPEN, BELGIUM  
Keynote on *The Role of Affective Polarisation and Radical Partisanship in the 2024 US Elections* at the *UAntwerpen American Election Night Event*

2022 – 2024 Thesis Advisor KU LEUVEN, BELGIUM  
3 master students

2022 Tutor MAASTRICHT UNIVERSITY, NETHERLANDS  
Bachelor course *Introduction to Quantitative Methods*

2021 – 2022 Student Assistant Supervisor MAASTRICHT UNIVERSITY, NETHERLANDS  
Supervising 2 bachelor students in interdisciplinary research project with Dr. Luana Russo and Dr. Darian Meacham

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2021 – 2022 Research Assistant MAASTRICHT UNIVERSITY, NETHERLANDS  
Project planning, data collection (N = 2,174) and analysis with Dr. Luana Russo and Dr. Darian Meacham  
Data collection and coding for Dr. Anna Herranz-Surrallés

2021 – 2022 Research Intern GESIS, GERMANY  
Data harmonisation and data documentation for the International Social Survey Programme and Horizon-funded *COORDINATE* project

## MEDIA

2025 News article in *Kleine Zeitung* on joint research  
Why the “firewall” against the far right is so fragile

- 2025 Blog piece in *The Loop ECPR's Political Science Blog*  
Coalition governments reduce partisan animosity—but only if they perform well
- 2024 Opinion piece in *De Tijd*  
Does polarisation threaten to paralyse Europa just like in the US?
- Interview in *De Ochtend*, Radio 1 (VRT)  
How consequential is 'affective' polarisation in Belgium?
- News article in *De Morgen* on joint research  
Radical-right voters are especially despised, but that matters little to them
- Blog post in *SWAY KU Leuven*  
Affective polarisation and the Belgian elections on 9 June 2024
- Interview by *Belga* on affective polarisation in Belgium  
Published in *Télésambre*, *7sur7*, *Grenz-Echo*, and *BRF Nachrichten*
- 2023 Blog piece in *Fondation Maison des Science de l'Homme* and *Montreal Centre for International Studies*  
How Tolerance for Disagreement Shapes Horizontal Affective Polarization

## SERVICE TO THE COMMUNITY

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- 2024 – 2025 Reviewer for *European Journal of Political Research*, *Government and Opposition*
- 2023 – 2024 Panel Chair  
ECPR General Conference 2023, ECPR General Conference 2024
- 2023 – 2024 Co-Developer Voting Advice Application for the 2024 Belgian Elections  
Filled out over 6 million times  
Winner of the 2025 University of Antwerp Prize for Societal Engagement

## SKILLS & INTERESTS

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- Statistical software STATA (proficient), R (proficient), SPSS (intermediate), Python (basic)
- Programmes Qualtrics (survey and experimental design), LaTeX, Git/Gitlab
- Languages Dutch (native), English (CEFR C2), German (CEFR C1), Danish (CEFR B2), French (CEFR B1)
- Hobbies Triathlon, harpsichord, violin, choir, marathon

## REFERENCES

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**Prof. Dr. Stefaan Walgrave**  
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University of Antwerp  
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**Prof. Dr. Ellen Claes**  
Associate Professor  
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